



Gear & Beer Fallfest proceeds go toward connecting bike trail

By **Bobby Kerlik**

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The Ohio River Trail Council is expecting more than 1,000 people to attend its fundraiser Sunday in Beaver County, which will feature bike rides, kayaking, canoeing, food, live music and beer tasting.

The Gear & Beer Tri-state Conservation Fallfest costs \$10 for admission for adults and \$25 to participate in an event, which includes rides ranging from 15 to 50 miles.

Vincent Troia, chairman and CEO of the Ohio River Trail Council, said proceeds will go toward bike trail development connecting the Montour Trail in Coraopolis to the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway trail.

“We want to have a continuous trail from the Great Lakes to Washington, D.C.,” Troia said. “This is the first (Beer & Gear Fallfest) we’ve done. We needed to expand awareness of the trail project and we needed to do a fundraiser.”

Troia said the trail is about 85 percent complete.

He expects 200 to 300 bikers to participate in the rides.

The event will take place from 9 a.m. to 5 p.m. at the Lodge at Bradys Run Park on Route 51, within Brighton and Patterson townships. Businesses have sponsored the event.

Craft beer sampling will include vendors from several wholesalers.

There will also be auctions, raffles and a children’s bike rodeo.

Bobby Kerlik is a staff writer for Trib Total Media.

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